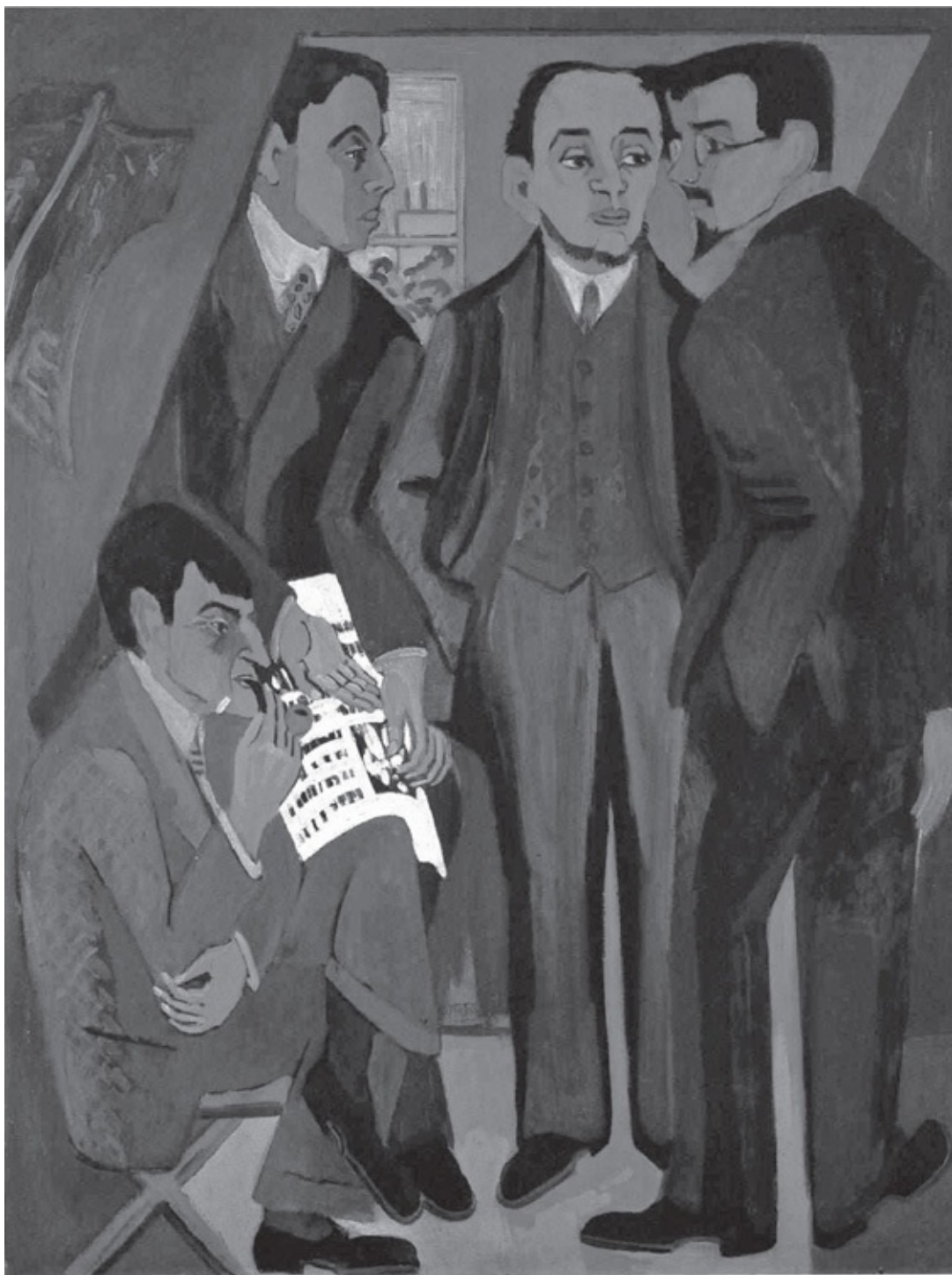


Die Brücke

In 1905, in Dresden, four German artists Fritz Bleyl (1880–1966), Erich Heckel (1883–1970), Ernst Ludwig Kirchner (1880–1938) and Karl Schmidt-Rottluff (1884–1976) formed Die Brücke ('The Bridge'). Later, others joined them, including van Dongen, Nolde, Max Pechstein and Otto Müller (1874–1930). Aiming to challenge and confront traditionally accepted styles of art, which by then included Impressionism and Post-Impressionism, their modern, urban subject matter, landscapes and figures also expressed radical political and social views. Like the Fauves, Die Brücke artists were fascinated by Primitivism, believing that their art would create a bridge between accepted art and more recent works. Inspired by the past as well as the present, they admired Dürer, Grünewald and Cranach the Elder, but used bright colours and unsophisticated techniques. Die Brücke held their first exhibition in 1906, publishing a group manifesto. Most members painted in a deliberately agitated, emotional style, exaggerating brilliant colours and shapes to emphasize particular aspects of each image.



Kirchner, *Group of Artists*, 1926-7